

Literature

Chapter 1: Poetry

Welcome to AnithUncommon's **Sample Resources!**

We are assuming you are reading this as a student. So What will **YOU** Expect From This Sample?

In Literature Chapter 1.1

This sample will be divided into three parts: Introduction to Samples (this part), Lesson Objectives (What is Expected From Students), and most crucially, Syllabus Contents.

Note that the 'Syllabus Content' does NOT stand as a complete syllabus itself; rather, it is a tight compilation of notes gathered by Ishraq to create a comprehensive sample for students.

If you want a complete version of these notes and think that you need help in Literature, join our nonprofit!

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This sample is made thanks to, Ishraq

— *Made by students, for students.*

Lesson Objectives:

At the end of the lesson, students should be *able* to...

- **Understand** the literal meaning of the poem
Identify who, where, and what is happening.
- **Evaluate** how effective the poet's techniques are
- **Explore** how structure and form shape meaning
(enjambment, contrast, etc)

Reflective Questions to Consider:

All poets have different interpretations of the poem they write, readers may even be able to point out things that even the writer had not thought of as they were writing the text.

Below are the following core questions you will face as we explore this chapter:

- What do you think is the poet's main message? Is it obvious or open to interpretation?
- Did any poem change the way you think about a particular theme (e.g., identity, conflict, nature)?

Unit 1: Poetry

Tip!

- Focus closely on the poet's choice of words, images, and techniques. Every word that stands out has been deliberately chosen for a reason, and it contributes to the overall meaning and effect of the poem.

Activities in Class:

- Lesson Breakdown
- Quizzes
- Debates

1.1 A Married state

This is a poem by Katherine Philips also known as the "Matchless Orinda" which highlights the **difficulty of pleasing husbands** and the **loss of personal freedom**.

Themes:

- Loss of freedom
- Female oppression

Symbolism:

- What does marriage symbolize? It can either symbolize **freedom** or **confinement**, depending on the circumstances. In this poem, Philips uses the state of marriage as confinement, showing that it's not all rainbows and sunshine, meaning women can lose their freedom and personal autonomy in this state.

Mentor's Notes

To understand this poem you must first understand its structure and form, as well as the tone of the poem.

Note that Katherines choice of not using enjambment and caesura adds to how she wants to convey this poem.

1.2 Sonnet 18

This is a poem by William Shakespeare, one of his sonnets from the many he had written. This sonnet in particular talks about

Mentor's Notes

Notice the shift from him talking about nature to bringing

how his beloved can live on through the art of poetry. Themes: - Immortality - Power of love Symbolism: - Shakespeare uses a lot of symbolism in this poem, such as “lease” meaning contract and “summer” which must come to an end at some point. He uses summer to compare his beloved to as a way of showing that though summer may end, his beloved will still live on through the art of poetry.	up things like a lease, as if summer takes a loan in order to be shown, though of course it’s going to still come to an end, this helps create a sense of urgency.
1.3 A Different History This poem by Sujata Bhatt from the era where British colonial rule was still a thing in India, the poem explores themes of postcolonial identity, the impact of colonization, and the relationship between language and culture, often reflecting her own experience as a poet born in India. Themes: - Postcolonial Identity - Language as a Living, Powerful Force Symbolism: - What does “different” history symbolize? Normally we would see the point of view from the winning side, however in this poem we see it from the perspective of someone who had actually gone through this, hence giving it its name A Different history	Mentor’s Notes Contrast the "Gods" with "shoes." Bhatt highlights Indian culture by showing Gods walking barefoot, symbolizing a pure connection to the land. The "shoes" symbolize Western colonization, which insulates and separates the wearer from that sacred earth.
1.4 Before The Sun This is a poem by Charles Mungoshi which explores the quiet tension and emotional distance within family relationships, especially between parents and children. It captures a moment early in the morning that reflects deeper feelings of fear,	Mentor’s Notes To understand this poem, focus on the narrative perspective (child’s

respect, and lack of communication. Themes: - Adolescence - Humans and nature Symbolism: -Morning, “before the sun” symbolizes a time of uncertainty and unease, suggesting emotional darkness before clarity.	view) and how the atmosphere is created. Mungoshi uses simple language but deep emotional implication, so students should read between the lines rather than just focusing on the literal meaning.
1.5 Carpet-Weavers, Morocco – Carol Rumens This is a poem by Carol Rumens that highlights the harsh reality of child labour in Morocco, contrasting the beauty of the carpets with the suffering of the children who make them. Themes: - Child labour and exploitation - Loss of childhood Symbolism: -What do the carpets symbolize? They symbolize the contrast between external beauty and internal suffering. While the carpets are admired, they are produced through the exploitation of children, showing how society often ignores the human cost behind attractive products.	Mentor’s Notes To understand this poem, focus on how Rumens uses contrast and imagery. Pay attention to: The contrast between the bright colours of carpets vs the harsh reality of children’s lives The tone (sympathetic, critical, ironic)

Mentors' Sources:

<https://www.litcharts.com/>

<https://poemanalysis.com/>

<https://www.cliffsnotes.com/>

<https://www.sparknotes.com/>

<https://www.savemyexams.com/igcse/english-literature/cie/21/>

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1HLR2FqizSkAStwginrWEAPd-ILRRP_io8XxXwobwKZc/edit?usp=sharing

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1VMMPe_hzoYxkYvG5Vb1bEMjPjBI-5k-iJOgSVh5C-hk/edit?usp=sharing

Youtube channels:

Claire's notes

Ms Duckworth's Classroom